

Letter to the Editor, Draft

Submitted to the Cody Enterprise by Charles McKay. Draft dated February 26, 2026.

To the Editor,

I have lived and ranched in this county my whole life, and I now serve the rural District 3 on the school board. I am writing about the proposal to consolidate Sage Creek Elementary and Pronghorn Valley Elementary, which the board will take up in a special session on November 10, 2026.

I have looked at what happened when four other Wyoming counties did the same thing. In Big Horn, Fremont, Carbon, and Sweetwater, the added bus time ran from thirty three to fifty two minutes each way, and three of the four lost students within two years. The savings were thin once the district paid to move children farther every day.

This is not about resisting change for its own sake. It is about a five year old on a bus before sunup in January for the better part of an hour. A school is the heart of a country community. Once it closes, the families follow it to town, and the country empties out a little more.

I am asking the district for three plain things before any vote. Measure the real winter drive times. Show the full cost, transportation added against buildings saved. Tell us how the youngest children will be cared for on the longest routes. If the numbers truly favor consolidation, show them. So far they have not.

Charles McKay

Park County School Board, District 3